

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



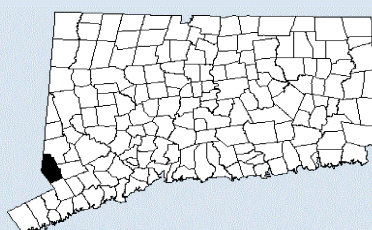
Ridgefield School District

Susie Dasilva, Superintendent • 203-894-5550 • <http://www.ridgefield.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	18
Enrollment	4,474
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$23,827
Total Expenditures ¹	\$109,055,396

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	2,180	48.7	48.3
Male	2,288	51.1	51.5
Non-Binary	6	0.1	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	281	6.3	5.2
Black or African American	36	0.8	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	415	9.3	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	203	4.5	4.7
White	3,530	78.9	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	88	2.0	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	318	7.1	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	796	17.8	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	126	5.8	16	0.7
Male	132	5.9	77	3.3
Non-Binary	0	*	0	*
Black or African American	0	0.0	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	43	10.3	13	3.0
White	199	5.7	72	2.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	9	9.3	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	35	10.4	15	4.0
Students with Disabilities	107	13.6	38	4.0
District	258	5.8	93	2.0
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 135

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	314.7
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	3.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	56.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	100.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	10.5
School Level	26.1
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	7.0
Support Staff	3.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	17.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	30.3
School Nurses	11.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	225.2

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.2	0.1
Asian	6	1.3	1.4
Black or African American	1	0.2	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	10	2.2	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	439	96.1	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.4	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	22	73.3	32	86.5
White	280	91.5	301	95.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	28	87.5	29	87.9
Students with Disabilities	34	81.0	62	83.8
District	340	90.2	370	94.6
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	81	63.3
Emotional Disability	34	66.7
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	212	78.8
Other Health Impairment	137	90.1
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	81	93.1
District	550	77.4
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	136	3.1	2.6
Emotional Disability	51	1.2	1.1
Intellectual Disability	11	0.2	0.6
Learning Disability	269	6.1	6.4
Other Health Impairment	156	3.5	3.5
Other Disabilities	29	0.7	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	100	2.3	2.0
All Disabilities	752	17.0	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$68,607,495	\$14,990	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$6,509,132	\$1,434	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$7,190,553	\$1,584	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,385,525	\$305	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$6,069,599	\$1,337	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$845,784	\$186	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$10,531,428	\$2,320	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$5,868,415	\$1,300	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$2,047,464	\$451	\$213
Total	\$109,055,396	\$23,827	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$7,595,040	32.5	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,718,152	11.6	10.2
Other Salaries	\$658,370	2.8	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$3,243,791	13.9	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,036,685	4.4	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$6,683,685	28.6	22.2
Supplies	\$82,600	0.4	0.7
Property Services	\$5,333	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,338,663	5.7	8.4
Equipment	\$37,850	0.2	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$23,400,169	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		21.5	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	96.4
State	1.9
Federal	1.6
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	144	88.5	144	91.8	65	88.3
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	11	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	205	72.9	200	69.4	90	71.2
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	102	82.8	101	80.3	43	80.3
White	1,891	79.9	1,881	78.2	814	77.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	65	67.7	63	69.5	25	67.8
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	2,297	80.2	2,283	78.6	998	77.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	164	72.7	161	69.9	71	69.8
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,198	80.4	2,185	78.9	952	78.1
Students with Disabilities	401	63.1	395	60.4	162	59.0
Students without Disabilities	1,961	83.3	1,951	81.9	861	81.0
High Needs	554	67.3	545	64.8	226	63.5
Non-High Needs	1,808	83.7	1,801	82.4	797	81.5
District	2,362	79.9	2,346	78.3	1,023	77.5

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	85.9	92.9	93.7	84.7	1,313	89.3
Curl Up	90.0	95.5	93.4	95.0	1,313	93.5
Push Up	80.3	79.3	82.7	84.4	1,268	81.6
Mile Run/PACER	78.5	89.8	85.0	54.5	1,305	77.1
All Tests - District	59.8	70.4	66.1	46.6	1,242	60.8
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	31	96.8
White	316	96.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	37	89.2
Students with Disabilities	66	78.8
District	394	96.2
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	306	81.6
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	6	*
Hispanic or Latino	49	73.1
White	487	78.3
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	39	60.0
Students with Disabilities	37	31.9
District	607	79.0
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	*	96.5
Male	86.8	98.1
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	83.9	*
White	88.4	97.5
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	85.7	96.3
Students with Disabilities	78.3	90.9
District	88.4	97.3
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	79.9	75	50.0	50	100.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	67.3	75	44.9	50	89.8	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	78.3	75	50.0	50	100.0	60.2
	High Needs Students	64.8	75	43.2	50	86.4	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	77.5	75	50.0	50	100.0	61.8
	High Needs Students	63.5	75	42.3	50	84.6	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	67.2%	100%	67.2	100	67.2	58.7%
	High Needs Students	58.8%	100%	58.8	100	58.8	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	74.8%	100%	74.8	100	74.8	61.4%
	High Needs Students	66.5%	100%	66.5	100	66.5	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	72.1%	100%	36.1	50	72.1	58.9%
	Oral	69.2%	100%	34.6	50	69.2	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	5.8%	<=5%	48.4	50	96.7	17.7%
	High Needs Students	11.9%	<=5%	36.3	50	72.6	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	92.4%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	79.0%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		95.3%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		96.2%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		90.6%	94%	96.4	100	96.4	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		88.4%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		89.9% 60.8%	75%	20.3	50	40.5	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		35.0%	60%	29.2	50	58.4	55.0%
Accountability Index				1199.0	1450	82.7	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	67.3	7.7	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	64.8	10.2	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	63.5	11.5	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	90.6%	3.4%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.2
	High Needs Students	95.0
Math	All Students	97.5
	High Needs Students	93.5
Science	All Students	96.2
	High Needs Students	91.7

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 64.1

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Ridgefield School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Ridgefield Public Schools is always seeking to grow ever better in systems, structures, professional learning, engagement, and communication with families. Creating a student-centered, equitable experience for all students continues to be the driving force as the district seeks to educate students to achieve the skills of the RPS Vision of the Graduate.

This drive is evident in the study and implementation of curriculum done in collaboration between Central Office and the schools. For example, our recent focus has been on 'rebooting' and aligning our MTSS system K-8 and determining what MTSS looks like at the high school. We have implemented a new data storage system and have fully implemented data team meetings at all of our schools. This work is done in collaboration with general and special education teachers and all of the upcoming professional learning will also be provided to all teachers and specialists across our schools.

RPS schools at all levels used a variety of strategies to continue to work on social-emotional support and build the bridge from home to the school community. We continue to assess and refine the implementation of tools and programs to support social-emotional learning and create a climate in our schools that is inclusive and all students feel that they belong and are able to access learning. In the 24-25 School Year we will be focusing on refining our MTSS systems and structures related to supporting students with SEL and behavior. This focus is alongside our renewed focus on all of our Tier 1 SEL and behavior tools and strategies for Tier 1 K-8.

This year communication to families continued to be a priority. RPS continued to provide and update a teacher and parent-facing website, send regular newsletters, and place positive phone calls home. The Superintendent sends out weekly updates and all buildings followed the 24-hour response guideline to connect back with family questions or concerns. We continue to update our district website which makes it easier to find and access information. We also provide a series of parent workshops, broadcast on our Curriculum YouTube Channel where parents could choose to watch live and submit questions or watch a recorded version at a time that works best for them. We are adding more workshops on SEL/Behavior to support the focus in this area at school and at home.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Ridgefield Public Schools continues to work to reduce isolation, racial, ethnic, economic, or any other type, as the District seeks to bring the mission and vision of the graduate to life for all students. This is evident in different ways across the levels. Students at the elementary level continue to experience classroom libraries that include windows into other cultures and perspectives, as well as mirrors into students' own lives. Students encounter many texts that include positive messages about culture, tolerance, empathy, and kindness. The ever-growing collections reinforce the inclusion and value of all students in RPS. This inclusion is not just evident in libraries, it is also evident in the authors that visit, through the support of the PTAs and the artists that students study in art class. Students learn to value the perspectives of others, navigate and recognize their own emotions as well as those of others, and how to handle conflict.

At the middle school level students continue to engage in learning about different perspectives. No Place for Hate continues to support our students and faculty at the middle and high school. Student learning is focused on curiosity, critical thinking, and questioning, especially in social studies and science instruction that engages in the inquiry cycle. This helps foster empathy and informed citizenship which can positively contribute to our culturally diverse and interdependent world. At the high school, various activities are implemented that collectively qualify the school to obtain the Anti-Defamation League's No Place for Hate (NPFH) designation. We held an interactive assembly program that focused on: understanding bias and prejudice and how to be an ally. In addition to these activities, the annual Man's Inhumanity to Man program was included in the NPFH designation. During the assembly program, 10th and 11th-grade students had the opportunity to hear the first-hand stories of Judith Altmann, a Holocaust survivor after studying about the time period in history class. At both the middle and high school level, staff continues to receive professional development from individuals and organizations devoted to supporting schools in creating welcoming and inclusive environments for all students and staff.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

RPS strives to create a student-centered, equitable experience for all students. This includes the equitable allocation of resources. At each of the levels, systems have been established to ensure this. The Elementary Director and 6-12 Supervisors support the schools in this work by evaluating and revising the curriculum and the MTSS process with teachers and administrators. Consistent class size guidelines, aligned collaborative professional learning across levels, and a push to memorialize curriculum were also done. Initiatives are identified through needs assessments and the curriculum review processes. These studies are clearly communicated and teachers are then supported at the classroom level to ensure consistency and calibration.

Hiring is a collaborative process. This district-wide approach results in high-quality candidates for all schools. At the funding level, RPS continues to use partial resource allocation based upon student enrollment, which provides equity in terms of student funding. Limited Title I and Title II funds are used to supplement the schools, based on a needs assessment and eligibility.